concepts are imaginary inventions. The instantaneous actualities behave in such a way that we can organise them under unifying concepts. Although the regularity (*svabhava-pratibandha*) between smoke and fire or that between something's being an oak and its being a tree holds primarily between two concepts, it also reflects a real state of affairs that causes us to make the connection between the concepts. ***Dharmakirti*** says that inference does not grasp the realities directly in that it operates by determining the object in a mental representation that is not itself the object. But because the representation of the object is understood because of some particular reality, the particular that is understood falls within the scope of the operation of inference.

Further reading: Dunne 2004; Tillemans 1999

Svabhava-vada (philosophical naturalism): the theory that the cosmos is unproduced and self-perpetuating. The cosmos is sustained by the mechanical operations of basic substances and their essential properties, regulated by natural laws.

See ***Carvaka***

Svalakshana (unique instant): according to the Buddhist ***Dignaga*** and his school, objective reality (***paramartha-sat***) consists of momentary unique particulars, each with a specific causal efficacy. They take the Buddhist ***Abhidharma*** notion of the basic atomic mental and material factors (***dharma***) underlying everything, each having a type of essence or unchanging nature (***svabhava***), and subtract the ***svabhava***. The remainder equals unique, inexpressible instants.

Each lasts just long enough for it to be replicated. Its existence is identical with the discharge of its causal activity. To be is to be effective. The *svalakshana* is a unique